

Gadget: BMW 750iL

Movie: *Tomorrow Never Dies*

This was the top-of-the-line BMW at the time. With a roaring V12 inside, this car also featured not one, not two, but 12 surface-to-surface missiles on the sunroof!

Coupled with Bond's Ericsson cell phone, this car was drivable via the controls on the phone without Bond being physically present in the car. Such an expensive piece of machinery would obviously need to have protection measures built in.

After the security system was activated, anyone who touched the car would get a rather nasty electric shock, and if he or she managed to recover from that, there were tear-gas dispensers incorporated as well.

To let Bond travel 'no strings attached', the BMW logo on the bonnet rose to form a cable snipper! The car also had metal tyre spikes deployed from underneath the rear bumper. The most mundane of the features were the re-inflatable tyres, which could re-inflate at the touch of a button after a puncture.

This technology is already in the market, with tyre companies selling 'Run Flat' and self-sealing tyres, wherein the tubeless tyres can take around 10 punctures and carry on without any problems.

Plausibility

The car is a complete fantasy, except for the remote-controlled driving and the re-inflatable tyres. Even the latter seem a little far-fetched the way they've been portrayed in the movie.

Coolness Quotient: 4.5

Plausibility: 1.5

Gadget: X-Ray Specs

Movie: *The World Is Not Enough*

The stuff that every kid's dreams are made of! The glasses are rather stylish (as are all things Bond!) and very functional. In the movie, they help Bond roam around a casino scanning for concealed weapons and inspecting ladies' lingerie.

Plausible?

Wouldn't it be simply great if they *were* plausible? We'd surely get one of those for our *New and Notable* reviews, not to mention a *30 days with...* article on it. But sadly, it's not to be. X-ray technology works on the principle of absorption and reflection, a lot like radar, and it works fine on guns, metals, and, of course, bones. But *not* on lingerie—it just doesn't reflect anything! 007 gets 000 here.

Coolness Quotient: 5

Plausibility: 0

Gadget: BMW Z8

Movie: *The World Is Not Enough*

If the BMW Z8 roadster, which can do 0-100 in less than five seconds, isn't enough eye-candy in itself, Q was at it again and added more weapons than the US carried into Iraq!

The car incorporated surface-to-air missiles, and a needle-thin sonic beam that let Bond eavesdrop on conversations in surrounding areas and buildings. It also had all the equipment from previous cars—rockets fitted behind headlamps, remote handset driving, and much more. The car, using sensors, could drive itself to where the remote control was located!

Q practically choked it with technology. The car had the absolute latest in intercepting equip-



The BMW Z8 being bisected by Bond's enemies

ment, surveillance and countermeasures. The car's body was redone and fitted with titanium plating and armour, and a multitasking heads-up display.

Plausible?

Yes. Even the sonic beam technology to eavesdrop on conversations was available in 1999, when the movie was released. It's currently being researched so it can work by bouncing off obstacles! The only thing is, we wonder if the car would really be able to carry the weight of all the heavy stuff—surface-to-air missiles included.

Coolness Quotient: 4

Plausibility: 4

Gadget: Aston Martin Vanquish

Movie: *Die Another Day*

In *Die Another Day*, Bond was back to his ever-faithful Aston Martin, as in the Vanquish V12.

As always, Q gave it a complete overhaul, post which the car had two under-hood mounted auto-aiming machine guns, front-firing rockets behind the main air intake grille, seat with spring-loaded ejection system, enhanced waterproofing, under-chassis air cannons, and central console-mounted controls.

This car was more feature-packed than any of the previous Bond cars. It incorporated four grille-mounted rockets plus two machine guns; two motion-sensing guns hidden under the bonnet; and spiked tyres for ice driving.

But all this was routine stuff which Bond has had movie after movie, so Q decided to do something new—and gave this car the capability to turn invisible at the flick of a button!

Plausible?

All the regular features of this car are plausible. And do we need to actually go ahead and state that a car that turns invisible is *not* plausible?!

Coolness Quotient: 5

Plausibility: 2

Over the years, James Bond has become synonymous with the absolute cutting edge in technology. There's now a controversy over who will play the next Bond, and with the death of Q, it would be interesting to see what MI6 can conjure up for Bond in the next movie. We just hope it is every bit as entertaining and far-fetched as the devices in the earlier movies! ■

varun_dubey@thinkdigit.com